

Richard Morland

Global Head of UX & Design · AI Enablement & Service Design Leader

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Professional Summary

Hands-on design leader and engineer by training, specialising in identifying practical use cases for growth that can be automated, digitised, and scaled. Over the last two decades, I have helped organisations turn complex technology into high-performing products. My track record includes introducing safe generative AI workflows at HSBC, scaling global design systems across 120+ brands at Diageo, and shaping digital platforms across the BBC, RBS, Nike, and Guinness. I focus on finding where automation unlocks real capacity, removing operational friction, and delivering measurable commercial growth.

Core Competencies

Design-to-Code Systems	Architecting global token structures, automated component variants, and centralized asset governance for multi-brand scale.
AI-Driven Orchestration	Deploying Human-AI Interaction (HAI) frameworks, conversational interfaces, and trust-mapping for operational accountability.
Strategic Service Experience	Leading end-to-end service blueprinting, Lean UX validation, and directing multidisciplinary squads to bridge technical silos.
Operational Excellence	Navigating strict regulatory guardrails and technical frontend partnerships to accelerate delivery velocity through DesignOps.
Product & Conversion Growth	Driving growth through heuristic auditing and data-informed product bets to deliver measurable commercial impact.

Professional Experience

SEAGLASS DIGITAL Founder & Principal Consultant	Kent, UK Aug 2026 – Present
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- AI Enablement: Embedding generative AI across the customer experience and human-centred design process end to end, from research synthesis and pattern-finding through to prototyping and continuous measurement,

applying the human-in-the-loop guardrails proven in regulated financial services.

- **Cost Savings:** Identifying where AI and design-system reuse remove duplicated effort across research, design and front-end delivery, targeting the operational overhead that scales with headcount rather than output.
- **Growth:** Converting customer insight into tested product change, applying the experimentation and conversion practice that delivered a 10% uplift and ~\$9M in incremental revenue at Diageo.

HSBC Innovation & AI Manager	London, UK (Hybrid) Sept 2025 – April 2026
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- **Championed AI-First Workflows:** Led design thinking and high-fidelity conversational prototyping for internal global Generative AI adoption, utilizing a "human-in-the-loop" model to safely accelerate deployment within a highly regulated environment.
- **Defined Trust & Control Boundaries:** Mapped internal operational friction points and user trust gaps between automated tools and global teams, replacing complex data-access workflows with intuitive conversational interfaces.
- **Delivered Cross-Functional Literacy Programs:** Designed and scaled weekly prompt-engineering training frameworks and support channels for 14,000+ global staff, rapidly accelerating internal tool adoption and aligning business intent with LLM logic.

DIAGEO Global Head of UX & Design DTC	London, UK (Hybrid) Oct 2018 – Aug 2025
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- **Scaled Iconic Design Systems:** Architected and deployed the multi-brand design system for 120+ brand web properties across 180+ markets, enforcing built-in accessibility compliance (WCAG 2.1 AA) at the atomic component layer.
- **Resolved Tech Adoption Friction:** Navigated deep engineering alignment battles by establishing a pragmatic hybrid migration path; collaborated with tech leads to utilize a baseline shadow out-of-the-box solution for immediate launch velocity, before refactoring variants into highly brand-flexible tokens that pushed code straight to production UI.
- **Delivered Craft at Scale:** Consolidated fragmented global agency networks into a centralized, data-driven workflow, slashing end-to-end development costs by 30% through front-end aware component reusability.
- **Optimized Continuous Experimentation:** Pioneered a culture of rapid testing on entry flows and compliance modules, validating a 10% conversion uplift that generated ~\$9M in incremental revenue.

WONGDOODY (INFOSYS) Design Service Lead	London, UK Jun 2016 – Oct 2018
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- **Retail Transformation:** Partnered with Fortune 500 retail and tech clients to translate complex business challenges into clear, actionable Service Design strategies.
- **Cross-Functional Leadership:** Assembled and directed multidisciplinary teams to deliver large-scale digital transformation projects.

FJORD (ACCENTURE) UX Program Manager	London, UK Nov 2015 – Jul 2016
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- **Agile Service Design Integration:** Championed the integration of Agile service design principles into legacy waterfall operations, overhauling the home-buying customer lifecycle by bridging in-branch physical retail advisor tools with consumer mobile applications.

METHOD INC UX Client Program Manager	London, UK 2014 – 2015
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- Led transformative client engagements, ensuring user experience drove product definitions and high-velocity delivery.

AKQA UX Program Manager (Nike+)	London, UK 2012
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- Spearheaded the integration of physical hardware and digital storytelling for immersive, kinetic "Phygital" innovations during the 2012 London Olympics.

IMAGINATION LTD Project Director (Ford)	London, UK 2011 – 2012
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- Directed Ford Vehicles Experience and Visual Design system with embedded critical safety validation for automotive HMI systems across multi-screen and Head-Up Displays.

BBC FM&T UX Design Project Manager	London, UK 2006 – 2011
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- Delivered V1 BBC iPlayer ground-breaking VOD service managing design teams and delivery partners; created interactive second-screen ecosystems unlocking BBC archives for user co-creation.

Technical Skills & Tooling

Design & Systems	Figma, Supernova, Vercel, Keynote, Miro, Adobe Creative Suite, Design Tokens, DesignOps.
Data & Analytics	GA4, Quantum Metric, UserTesting, Hotjar, Clarity, Conversion Rate Optimisation (CRO).
Generative AI	Prompt Engineering (Gemini, Claude, Perplexity), LLM Integration Strategy, Human-AI Interaction (HAI).
Product & Delivery	Jira, Azure DevOps, Microsoft 365 (Teams, SharePoint, Excel), Agile/Scrum, Service Blueprinting.
Technologies	Python, React, Java, HTML/CSS (Front-end Architecture), IoT Sensors, shadcn/ui.

Education & Certifications

BSc (Hons) Optoelectronic Engineering and Laser Physics	University of Northumbria
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Certifications: Responsible AI (LinkedIn Learning) · Agile Scrum Master · PRINCE2 Practitioner · Google Data Analytics Certificate (In Progress)